CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

Issue 007 Monday, November 9, 2026 · Biweekly, 4 pages

Building & Mechanical

HVAC · Plumbing · Electrical · Solar & Storage · Commercial Refrigeration

Five trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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BACKGROUND SIGNAL
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

MONEY

Carrier will raise residential HVAC equipment prices 8% toward the end of the fourth quarter, while Lennox cut its 2026 profit outlook and distributors reported September sales up 9%.

Carrier said on its October 29 earnings call that it will raise residential HVAC equipment prices 8% toward the end of the fourth quarter, and 10% across its Climate Solutions Americas business. Residential field inventory ended the third quarter about flat from a year earlier, and Carrier expects year-end field inventory to be about flat too, ACHR News reported November 2.

Carrier's Climate Solutions Americas residential sales rose more than 30% in the third quarter, after a 12% decline in the first. It now puts its Climate Solutions Americas residential market in 2026 at 7.5 million to 8 million units, and says side-discharge equipment, including ductless and crossover hybrids, is about 20% of that market.

ACHR News reported October 30 that Lennox's Home Comfort Solutions revenue rose 3% to $937 million after declines of 7% in the second quarter and 10% in the first, but underlying volume fell 3% and segment profit fell 18%, with margin down 490 basis points to 18.7%. Lennox lowered 2026 adjusted earnings guidance to $21.00 to $21.50 from $23 to $24 and now expects residential revenue down about 4% for the year, against growth of 1% before.

HARDI's September survey, reported by ACHR News in November, shows distributor sales up 9% from a year earlier and up 3.7% over the trailing 12 months, inside the 2.5% to 4.5% range of the past two years. HARDI's Brian Loftus said cooling degree days rose more than 40% from September 2025, and that "a breakout to the upside looks unlikely with existing home sales and new construction trending flat to down."

What to do about it: Pull your last 20 replacement quotes and total the equipment line on each; adding 8% to that line shows what the Carrier increase does to your margin if you do not reprice. Ask each distributor in writing for the effective date of Carrier's increase and whether orders placed before it hold current pricing. Ask your other equipment lines whether they have announced matching dates, and decide this week whether December quotes need new numbers. Keep every price notice with the date you received it, so you can show a customer why a quote changed. Before you commit to a bulk order, ask your distributor how much year-end inventory it plans to carry.

ACHR News: Carrier residential rebounds, price hikes loom · ACHR News: Lennox residential HVAC revenue improves in Q3 · ACHR News: HVACR distributor sales jump 9% in September

HVAC

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

A House bill would make federal agencies pay small contractors at least half their estimated cost on government-directed change orders; committee approval was 23-0 and ACHR News reported it October 29.

Why it matters: H.R. 4615, the Small Business Payment for Performance Act of 2026, would require an interim payment of at least 50% of estimated cost on a qualifying request for equitable adjustment. The House Small Business Committee approved it 23-0 on September 16 and reported an amended version October 9; there was no floor vote as of October 16, and the Senate must also pass it. Subcontractors would receive pass-through payments, but the bill would not give every subcontractor a direct claim against the agency. If you hold federal work, put every directed change in writing with a cost estimate the day it is issued.

ACHR News: House bill would pay federal change orders

REGULATION

After the November 3 midterms, ACCA and PHCC still want the 25C, 25D and 179D tax credits restored, but neither party has the 60 Senate votes to move its agenda easily.

Why it matters: ACHR News reported November 4 that about four or five working weeks remain in this Congress, and that spending bills could carry HVAC tax and permitting provisions. Rep. Brian Fitzpatrick (R-PA), author of a commercial tax credit bill, lost reelection. The 25C credit ended December 31, 2025; SMUD's gas-to-electric heat pump rebate has been $2,000 to $3,000 plus a $2,000 panel bonus since February 1. Advocates say refrigerant and efficiency fights are moving to state legislatures. Tell customers which rebates remain, and call your state legislators.

ACHR News: The midterms changed the map for HVAC · ACHR News: Life after the federal credit

PLUMBING

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

American Tube & Pipe and Southwark raised prices 8% on November 1, Artis Metals 6% and IBC Tankless 5% on November 2, and Gastite will add 6% on November 23.

Why it matters: The trade lists, both updated November 4, show American Tube & Pipe at 8% on its entire line and Gastite at 6% on CSST, fittings and accessories. Crane, Ridgid and Resideo/Honeywell also posted November 1 increases without a stated percent. The lists say they will be updated as more increases are announced. Check open bids that include gas piping or hydronic valves against the new sheets, and ask your distributor to confirm in writing whether CSST ordered before November 23 holds today's price.

Plumbing & Mechanical: PHCP-PVF price increases, Nov. 2026 · Supply House Times: PHCP-PVF price increases, Nov. 2026

DEMAND

Contractor reported October 29 that Trust in Water estimates 9.2 million lead service lines remain in use, and EPA puts drinking water system needs at $625 billion over 20 years.

Why it matters: Trust in Water, urging incoming leaders to act in 2027, cites EPA's $625 billion estimate as a 32% increase from the prior assessment, about 450,000 miles of water main past useful life and about 240,000 main breaks a year. It asks policymakers to protect state revolving funds, create a permanent federal water affordability program and widen Clean Water State Revolving Fund eligibility. Ask your local utility when its next pipe-replacement bids are due, and whether it needs private-side plumbing partners.

Contractor: Trust in Water urges 2027 infrastructure focus

ELECTRICAL

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

A 400-amp service upgrade can cost more than $20,000 and delay a closing 8 to 12 weeks, while main panel upgrades carry a 25% contractor margin, EC&M reported November 2.

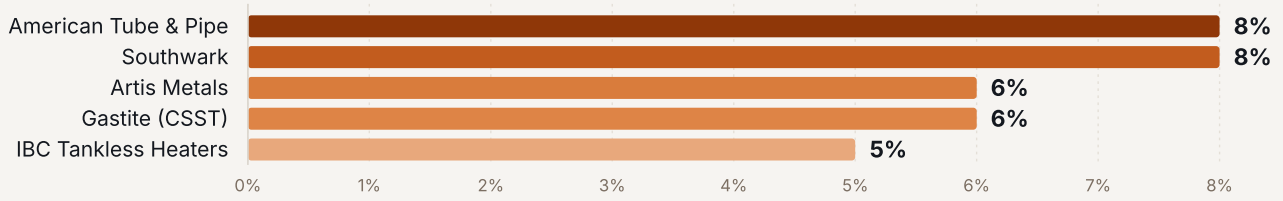
Why it matters: ABB's white paper, cited by EC&M, says a 400A upgrade can trigger utility engineering reviews, transformer requirements and trenching permits, and that upwards of 60% of U.S. homes could need panel upgrades to go all-electric. An EnergySage contractor survey puts main panel upgrade margin at 25%, the highest product measured, and EV charger installs at 24%. Smart panels shed loads to avoid service upgrades in new construction, and circuit-level add-ons bring load control to existing panels. Price a load-management option beside every 400A quote this week.

EC&M: Tech could ease home electrification upgrades

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / NOVEMBER PIPE AND VALVE PRICES

Plumbing and hydronic makers posted November increases of 5% to 8%, led by American Tube & Pipe and Southwark at 8%.

Announced list-price increases, percent; PHCP-PVF price list updated November 4, 2026 (Plumbing & Mechanical); entries with a stated percent only



American Tube & Pipe and Southwark took effect November 1, Artis Metals and IBC Tankless November 2, and Gastite takes effect November 23. Crane, Ridgid and Resideo/Honeywell also posted November 1 increases without a stated percent. Match each maker to the lines in your open bids and ask your distributor to confirm in writing which orders hold the old price.
Plumbing & Mechanical: PHCP-PVF price increases, Nov. 2026

ELECTRICAL

CONTINUED

SUPPLY

LS Electric plans to triple switchgear production at its Utah campus with a $168 million investment through 2030, EC&M reported October 23.

Why it matters: The campus in Iron County, Utah, would grow from about 13,223 square feet to roughly 79,338 square feet, with three new production buildings by 2030. The Utah Inland Port Authority approved a property tax reduction of up to 30% of the increase from the expansion, over 25 years. The plant makes UL-compliant switchgear and power distribution systems for data centers, critical infrastructure and other large projects. Ask your gear distributor for current switchgear lead times before you commit to a delivery date on a bid.

EC&M: LS Electric invests $168M in Utah switchgear

SOLAR & STORAGE

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Enphase reported, per PV Tech October 28, that U.S. sell-through fell 35% from a year earlier in the third quarter, and it guided fourth-quarter revenue to $225 million to $255 million.

Why it matters: Enphase's U.S. sell-through rose 5% from the second quarter, and Enphase attributes U.S. residential weakness to high interest rates and the expiration of the Section 25D credit. Its guidance assumes sell-through down 10% from the third quarter. Battery shipments were 129.9 MWh against 113.8 MWh in the second quarter; Enphase expects residential battery shipments to rise from 450 MWh in 2026 to about 675 MWh in 2027. Ask your distributor for current battery lead times and price sheets before you quote 2027 jobs.

PV Tech: Enphase Q3 2026, storage key growth driver · TaiyangNews: Enphase Q3 2026 financial results

DEMAND

Sunrun installed 204 megawatts of solar in the third quarter, down 15% from a year earlier, while a record 75% of its installs included storage.

Why it matters: PV Tech reported November 5 that Sunrun's storage installed was 374 MWh, down 9% from a year earlier, and that its attachment rate was 75% against 70% a year earlier and 74% in the second quarter. Sunrun revised full-year cash generation guidance to about $200 million, from $200 million to $375 million. It put its networked storage at 5 GWh, and its distributed power plant supplied more than 430 MW of a 745 MW dispatch event on October 6. If you quote solar without a battery, add a storage option to every residential proposal this week.

PV Tech: Sunrun reaches 5GWh, Q3 installs fall 15%

COMMERCIAL REFRIGERATION

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

Commercial refrigeration appliances holding 15 pounds or more of high-GWP HFC have been under EPA leak-repair rules since January 1, 2026, with a 20% leak-rate trigger and a 30-day repair deadline.

Why it matters: ACHR News reported June 10 that a failed repair requires a retrofit or retirement plan within 30 days, a follow-up test within 10 days of the initial test and three years of records. The article's author, a compliance-software executive, says equipment owners have absorbed roughly $100 million in EPA penalties and contractors have faced 41 actions totaling $2.7 million. EPA's page, updated December 8, 2025, lists the same 20% and 30-day figures for appliances of 50 pounds or more. Pull each customer's charge sizes and leak logs, and fix the paperwork gaps before an inspector asks.

ACHR News: Leak rules tighten as threshold drops to 15 lb · EPA: Stationary refrigeration leak repair requirements

SUPPLY

Trane Technologies agreed to acquire Cancoil Thermal, a maker of air-cooled condensers, fluid coolers and finned-tube coils, with closing expected before the end of the year.

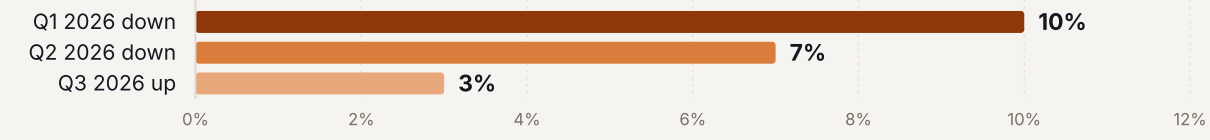
Why it matters: ACHR News reported the deal October 23. It includes Cancoil's Ontario plants, its U.S. operations in Jacksonville, Texas, and more than 450 employees; Cancoil already supplies Trane's chiller and airside businesses. Ask your equipment suppliers this week whether any Cancoil-built units are in your open orders, and get lead times and pricing for year-end deliveries in writing.

ACHR News: Trane to acquire heat-transfer maker

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / LENNOX RESIDENTIAL TURN

Lennox's residential revenue stopped falling in the third quarter, rising 3% after declines of 10% and 7% in the first two quarters.

Home Comfort Solutions revenue, percent change from a year earlier, direction in label; Q1-Q3 2026 per ACHR News, October 30, 2026

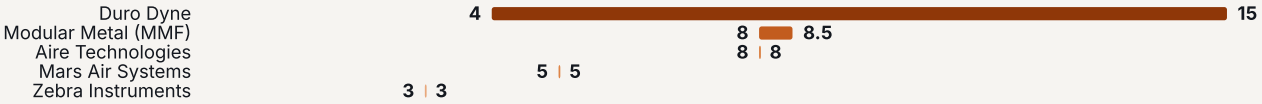


Lennox's third-quarter residential revenue rose 3% to $937 million, but underlying volume fell 3% and acquisitions added 4%. Segment profit fell 18% and margin fell 490 basis points to 18.7%. The gain is not a volume recovery; check your own December replacement bookings against last year's before you add crews or inventory. ACHR News: Lennox residential HVAC revenue improves in Q3

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / HVAC PARTS INCREASES

HVAC parts and duct makers announced November increases of 3% to 15%, with Duro Dyne spanning 4% to 15% by product category.

Announced list-price increases, percent, low to high; ACHR News HVAC price increase list, November 4, 2026; makers whose rows show one value announced a single percent



Duro Dyne's 4% to 15% varies by product category; MMF's 8% applies to metal and 8.5% to aluminum products. Aire (8%), Mars Air (5%) and Zebra (3%) posted flat rates, all effective November 1 or 2. Parker Hannifin's HVAC filtration division (November 16) and Airzone (November 23) have dates but no stated percent. Get the category sheet from Duro Dyne's distributor before you reprice duct jobs. ACHR News: HVAC price increase list, November 2026

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

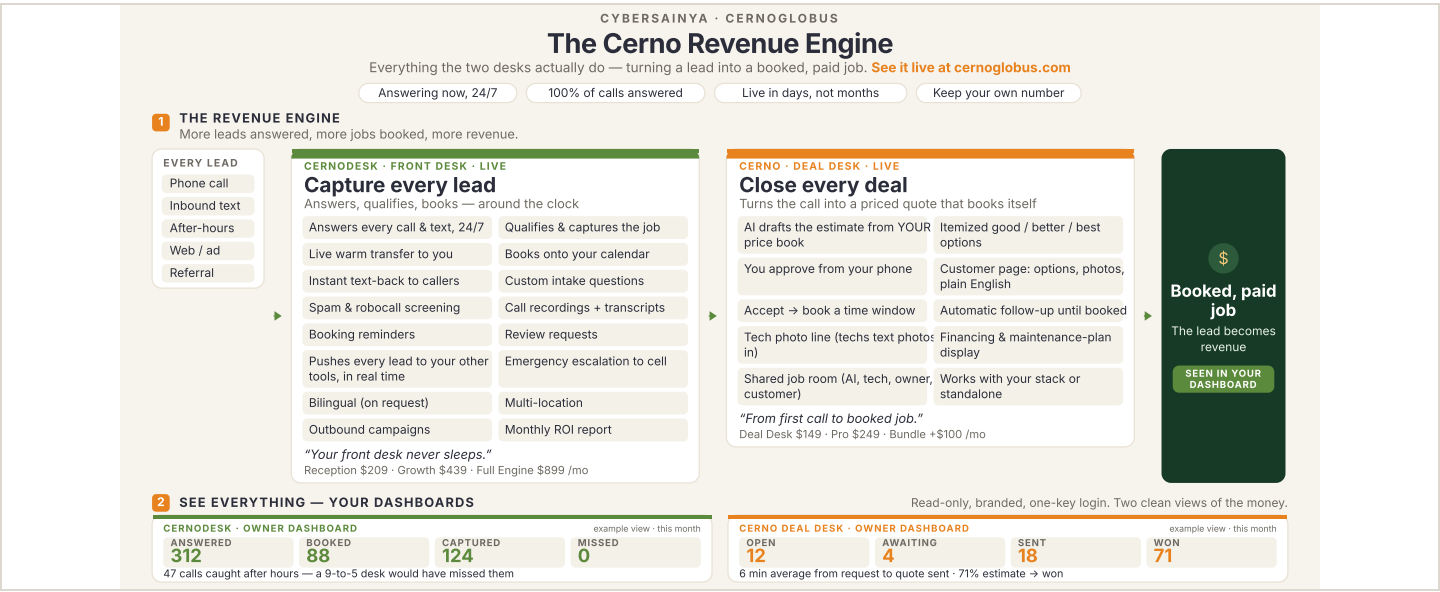
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a mechanical contractor. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A trade that emails quotes, change orders and supplier invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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